

# Apache OpenOffice

Version 4.1

## Calc Guide

AOO Documentation Team

### **Appendix C** **Calc Error Codes**

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## Acknowledgments

This document is updated from a previous version by the OOoAuthors team. The AOO Documentation Team appreciates the many contributions of Michael Scarborough and Michele Petrovsky.

## Publication date and software version

Published August 25, 2025. Based on Apache OpenOffice 4.1.

## Note for Mac Users

Some keystrokes and menu items differ on a Mac from those used in Windows and Linux. The table below gives some common substitutions for the instructions in this chapter. For a more detailed list, see the application Help.

| <b><i>Windows/Linux</i></b>                 | <b><i>Mac equivalent</i></b>       | <b><i>Effect</i></b>            |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| <b>Tools &gt; Options</b><br>menu selection | <b>OpenOffice &gt; Preferences</b> | Access setup options            |
| <i>Right-click</i>                          | <i>Control+click</i>               | Open context menu               |
| <i>Ctrl</i> (Control)                       | ⌘ (Command)                        | Used with other keys            |
| <i>F5</i>                                   | <i>Shift+⌘+F5</i>                  | Open the Navigator              |
| <i>F11</i>                                  | <i>⌘+T</i>                         | Open Styles & Formatting window |

# Contents

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**Appendix C**

**Calc Error Codes..... 1**

    Introduction to Calc Error Codes.....4

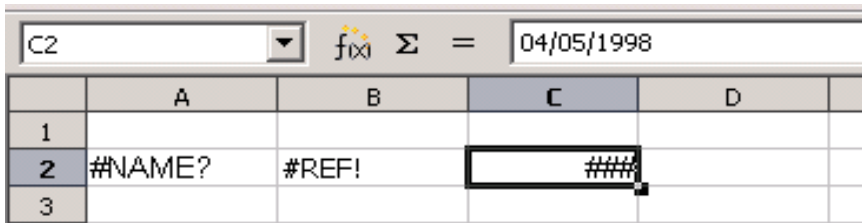
    Error Codes Displayed Within Cells.....5

    General Error Codes.....6

# Introduction to Calc Error Codes

Calc provides feedback for errors in calculation, incorrect use of functions, invalid cell references and values, and other user-initiated mistakes. The feedback may be displayed within the cell that contains the error (Figure 1), on the status bar (Figure 2), or in both, depending on the type of error. In general, if the error occurs in the cell that is selected (or contains the cursor), the error message is displayed on the status bar as well as in the cell.

For example, Figure 1 shows three error codes. In cell C1, it shows the error returned when a column is too narrow to display the entire formatted date. The date displayed within the input line, 04/05/2021, would fit within the cell without a problem; however, the format used by the cell produces the date value *Monday, April 05, 2021*. The simplest solution is to make the column wider.

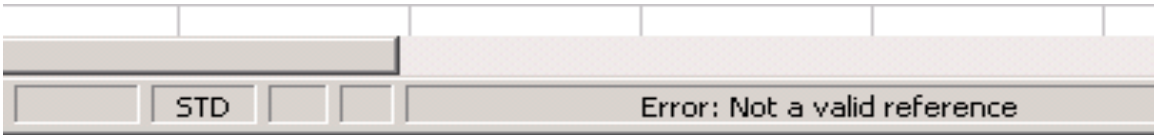


The screenshot shows a Calc spreadsheet with a formula bar at the top displaying 'C2' and a date '04/05/1998'. Below the formula bar is a grid of cells. Row 1 has columns A, B, C, and D. Row 2 shows error codes: '#NAME?' in A2, '#REF!' in B2, and '###' in C2. Row 3 is empty.

|   | A      | B     | C   | D |
|---|--------|-------|-----|---|
| 1 |        |       |     |   |
| 2 | #NAME? | #REF! | ### |   |
| 3 |        |       |     |   |

Figure 1: Error codes displayed within cells

When the cell displaying the **#REF** error code in Figure 1 is selected, the status bar displays the error message as shown in Figure 2. This message is more descriptive than the one displayed in the cell, but it may not provide enough information to correctly diagnose the problem. For a more detailed explanation, consult the following tables and the Help topic, “Error Codes in OpenOffice Calc.”



The screenshot shows the status bar at the bottom of the Calc window. It contains the text 'Error: Not a valid reference'.

|     |                              |
|-----|------------------------------|
| STD | Error: Not a valid reference |
|-----|------------------------------|

Figure 2: An error message displayed in the status bar.

This appendix presents error codes in two tables. The first table explains error messages displayed within the cell that contains the error. Except in the case of the **###** error, they all correspond to a Calc error code number. The second table explains all the error codes, listed by code number, including those listed in the first table.

## Error Codes Displayed Within Cells

| <b>Cell error</b> | <b>Code</b> | <b>Explanation of the error</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-------------------|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ###               | N/A         | The column is too narrow to display the complete, formatted contents of the cell. There is no corresponding numerical error code. The solutions to this problem are to increase the width of the column or select <b>Format &gt; Cells &gt; Alignment</b> and click either <i>"Wrap text automatically"</i> or <i>"Shrink to fit cell size"</i> to make the text match the current column width. |
| Err:502           | 502         | Function argument is not valid, or the DGET function finds more than one matching cell.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| #NUM!             | 503         | A calculation resulted in a value that exceeded the defined range of acceptable values.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| #VALUE            | 519         | The formula in the cell returns a value that does not correspond to the definition of the formula or the functions used. This error could also mean that the cell referenced by the formula contains text instead of a number.                                                                                                                                                                   |
| #REF!             | 524         | The formula in the cell uses a reference that does not exist. Either a column or row description name could not be found, or the column, row, or sheet that contains a referenced cell is missing.                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| #NAME?            | 525         | An identifier could not be evaluated; for example, it may not contain a valid reference, domain name, column/row label, macro, or an incorrect decimal divider, or the add-in may not be found. For example, entering in a cell =sum(bob*5) where there is no cell named "bob" or containing the text "bob" generates this error.                                                                |
| #DIV/0!           | 532         | Division operator / if the denominator is 0.<br>Some additional functions return this error; see the next table for details.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |

## General Error Codes

The following table is an overview of the most common error messages for OpenOffice Calc.

### Note

Errors described as *Internal errors* should not be encountered by users under normal conditions. Errors described as *Not used* are not currently assigned to any error condition.

| Code | Message                                                | Explanation of the error                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 501  | Invalid character                                      | Character in a formula is not valid. This error is the same as the <i>Invalid Name</i> error (525) except that it occurs within a formula. The cell containing the error will display the #NAME? error reference. |
| 502  | Invalid argument                                       | Function argument is not valid; for example, a negative number for the root function. This error also occurs if the DGET function finds more than one matching cell.                                              |
| 503  | Invalid floating point operation (cell displays #NUM!) | Division by 0, or another calculation that results in a value too big or too small.                                                                                                                               |
| 504  | Parameter list error                                   | Function parameter is not valid; for example, text instead of a number, or a domain reference instead of a cell reference.                                                                                        |
| 505  | Internal syntax error                                  | Not used.                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 506  | Invalid semicolon                                      | Not used.                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 507  | Pair missing                                           | Not used.                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 508  | Pair missing                                           | Missing bracket or parenthesis; for example, closing brackets but no opening brackets.                                                                                                                            |
| 509  | Missing operator                                       | Operator is missing; for example, =2 (3+4) , where the operator between "2" and "(" is missing.                                                                                                                   |
| 510  | Missing variable                                       | Variable is missing; for example, when two operators are together =1+*2.                                                                                                                                          |
| 511  | Missing variable                                       | Function requires more variables than are provided; for example, AND() and OR().                                                                                                                                  |

| <b>Code</b> | <b>Message</b>                                   | <b>Explanation of the error</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 512         | Formula overflow                                 | The total number of internal tokens (that is, operators, variables, brackets) in the formula exceeds 512, or the total number of matrices the formula creates exceeds 150. This includes basic functions that receive an array that is too large as a parameter. |
| 513         | String overflow                                  | An identifier in the formula exceeds 64 KB in size, or a result of a string operation exceeds 64 KB in size.                                                                                                                                                     |
| 514         | Internal overflow                                | Sort operation attempted on too much numerical data (max. 100000) or a calculation overflow.                                                                                                                                                                     |
| 515         | Internal syntax error                            | Not used.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 516         | Internal syntax error                            | Matrix is expected on the calculation stack, but it is not available.                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 517         | Internal syntax error                            | Unknown error; for example, a document with a newer function is loaded in an older version of Calc that does not contain the function.                                                                                                                           |
| 518         | Internal syntax error                            | Variable is not available.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 519         | No result (cell displays <b>#VALUE</b> )         | Formula yields a value that does not correspond to the definition, or a cell that is referenced in the formula contains text instead of a number.                                                                                                                |
| 520         | Internal syntax error                            | Compiler creates an unknown compiler code.                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 521         | Internal syntax error                            | No result.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 522         | Circular reference                               | Formula refers directly or indirectly to itself, and the <b>Iterations</b> option is not selected under <b>Tools &gt; Options &gt; OpenOffice Calc &gt; Calculate</b> .                                                                                          |
| 523         | The calculation procedure does not converge      | Financial statistics function missed a targeted value, or iterations of circular references do not reach the minimum change within the maximum steps that are set.                                                                                               |
| 524         | Invalid references (cell displays <b>#REF!</b> ) | A column or row description name could not be resolved, or the column, row, or sheet that contains a referenced cell is missing.                                                                                                                                 |
| 525         | Invalid names (cell displays <b>#NAME?</b> )     | An identifier could not be evaluated; for example, it may not contain a valid reference, domain name, column/row label, macro, or an incorrect decimal divider, or the add-in may not be found.                                                                  |

| <b>Code</b> | <b>Message</b>        | <b>Explanation of the error</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 526         | Internal syntax error | Obsolete, no longer used, but could come from old documents.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 527         | Internal overflow     | References, such as when a cell references a cell, are too encapsulated, or deeply nested.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| 528–531     | —                     | Not used.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 532         | Division by zero      | <p>Division operator / if the denominator is 0.</p> <p>Several functions return this error; for example:</p> <p>VARP with less than 1 argument</p> <p>STDEVP with less than 1 argument</p> <p>VAR with less than 2 arguments</p> <p>STDEV with less than 2 arguments</p> <p>STANDARDIZE with stdev=0</p> <p>NORMDIST with stdev=0</p> |